

LEARNING SYSTEMS PORTFOLIO

Larisa Forbs

Selected Learning Design Projects

Instructional design, learning strategy, digital learning, knowledge translation, and performance support for complex environments.

ABOUT

Translating complex knowledge into accessible learning.

I design learning systems and experiences that make difficult material understandable, structured, and usable without flattening its complexity.

My work spans corporate learning, technical and safety-critical environments, public education, multilingual audiences, and independent learning initiatives. Across those contexts, the design problem is remarkably consistent: preserve the integrity of the knowledge while making it actionable for real people in real situations.

I work across the full learning-design cycle: performance and needs analysis, curriculum architecture, scenario design, digital development, facilitation, deployment, and evaluation.

Complexity is not the enemy.
Unstructured complexity is.



Learning Architecture

Needs Analysis

Knowledge Translation

Performance Support

LMS / SCORM

What I design

A portfolio organized around capability, not software.

Learning Strategy & Architecture

Needs analysis, program architecture, standards, measurement, governance, and scalable learning systems.

Digital Learning & Deployment

Rise 360, SCORM, LMS deployment, HTML/CSS, QA, tracking, and responsive digital learning experiences.

Story-Driven Performance Support

Narrative design, animation, behavior modeling, staff enablement, reflection, and change-oriented learning.

Knowledge Translation

Academic, technical, sensitive, and multilingual content translated into usable learning without loss of rigor.

VividWorld Apparel Onboarding

A learner-centered first-30-days experience designed to accelerate readiness, confidence, and consistent customer experience behaviors.



Open live case

Design Challenge

Build onboarding as mutual adaptation rather than one-directional information transfer, while reducing early uncertainty and supporting time-to-productivity.

- Progressive pathway: Context → Identity → Role → Practice → Application → Growth → Independence
- Scenario-based interaction, reflection, and applied decision-making
- IMPACT customer experience framework
- Micro-interactions to control cognitive load

My Role

Instructional Designer Platform: Articulate Rise 360
Audience: New Customer Experience Specialists

What this demonstrates

Onboarding

Scenario Design

Self-Efficacy

Growth Mindset for Performance & Leadership

A behavior-focused learning program for experienced professionals who needed more constructive responses to failure, feedback, and team debriefs.



Open live case

Business Problem

Strong technical performers struggled with failure tolerance, feedback defensiveness, learning from mistakes, and blame-oriented post-mortems. The business needed behavior change, not awareness-level training.

- Performance-based design around observable behaviors
- Realistic client-loss dialogue and scenario-based learning
- Professional, non-preachy behavior modeling
- Choice architecture and reflection for transfer

My Role

Lead Instructional Designer & Learning Architect
Audience: Mid-level professionals and people managers

Reported Impact

- Greater openness around mistakes
- Improved debrief quality
- More constructive manager feedback
- Higher engagement than prior soft-skills programs

High-Risk Industry Training

Learning for engineers and technical professionals operating across language, safety, and performance constraints.



Open live case

Instructional Context

Training had to preserve technical accuracy while remaining accessible for international professionals and non-native English speakers in safety-critical environments.

- Safety Culture in Nuclear Industry
- Presenting Technical Data and Charts
- Interview Readiness for International Technical Assignments
- Translation-friendly language and structured communication

Design Principle

Accessibility should not require reducing the technical integrity of the content.

What this demonstrates

Technical Training

Multilingual Design

High-Stakes Learning

Did Pedro Fail? Or Did We Fail Pedro?

An animated learning experience that challenges assumptions about learner attrition, pathway visibility, and institutional responsibility.



Watch Pedro's story

Pedro did not fail to find the pathway.
We failed to make the pathway visible.

Performance Opportunity

Adult Education career pathways cannot change lives when learners do not know they exist or cannot see how current classes connect to future economic goals.

Learning Strategy

- Narrative reversal: viewers first see the successful ending that never happened
- Counterfactual storytelling to make the institutional gap emotionally tangible
- Reflection before instruction
- Systems framing that shifts the question from learner deficit to institutional responsibility

My Contribution

- Performance opportunity analysis
- Systems analysis
- Narrative strategy
- Storyboarding & scriptwriting
- AI-assisted production
- Animation

Intended Impact

Greater pathway visibility, stronger retention, more purposeful staff conversations, and institutional reflection.

Understanding Xenophobia

A self-paced and facilitated learning experience translating social psychology and intercultural research into structured reflection and dialogue.



Open live case

Design Challenge

Create accessible learning about a sensitive, complex topic without oversimplifying it or compromising psychological safety.

- Interactive Rise 360 modules
- Reflection prompts and scenario-based exercises
- Multiple entry points for self-paced and facilitated learning
- Explicit psychological-safety framing
- Grounded in social psychology, sociology, and intercultural studies

My Role

Instructional Designer • Content Creator • Educational Facilitator

What this demonstrates

Sensitive Topics

Reflection Design

Psychological Safety

Queerology: Identity, Power & Social Structures

Academic translation and facilitation for non-academic audiences across diverse cultural and educational backgrounds.



Open live case

Problem

A gap existed between academically rigorous theory and accessible public education. Existing resources were often either inaccessible or oversimplified.

- Curated peer-reviewed literature and academic frameworks
- Synthesized theory into structured instructional narratives
- Translated and adapted concepts into a language with limited established academic resources
- Balanced rigor, accessibility, cognitive load, and psychological safety
- Designed live webinars with moderated discussion and guided meaning-making

My Role

Instructional Designer • Content Curator • Facilitator • Academic Translator

Results

- High live-session engagement
- Strong feedback on clarity
- Increased learner confidence
- Repeat attendance

Forbes School Learning System

A ground-up learning ecosystem integrating diagnostics, curriculum, assessment, learner grouping, and LMS-supported progress tracking.



Open live case

System Challenge

Traditional language programs were failing underserved learners through weak placement, rigid curricula, limited differentiation, and poor progress visibility.

- Needs-first diagnostics and learner profiling
- Modular curriculum architecture
- Age-sensitive grouping and scaffolded progression
- Continuous formative assessment
- LMS-enabled transparency and accountability

My Role

End-to-End Instructional Designer • Curriculum Architect • Assessment Designer • LMS Implementation Lead

Impact

- Improved retention through accurate placement
- Measurable learner progress
- High learner and stakeholder satisfaction
- Scalable system across cohorts

CONTACT

Let's build learning that makes complexity usable.

For the full interactive portfolio, live course previews, animation, and current work, visit the online portfolio.

Portfolio forbslarisa-lx.github.io/portfolio/

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Focus Instructional Design • Learning Strategy • eLearning • Performance Support



Open interactive portfolio